

Nile Generic Neg: Critical Minerals

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Ross Wilson and Thom Rabren

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Inherency

Inherency 1) Across the Board Inherency

Gracelin Baskaran, January 15, 2026, *(Dr. Gracelin Baskaran is director of the Critical Minerals Security Program at the Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS). She is a mining economist and has spent over a decade working on critical minerals globally. She began her career in South Africa's platinum belt and later spent five years at the World Bank in South Africa, where she coauthored the book Africa's Resource Future: Harnessing Natural Resources for Economic Transformation during the Low-Carbon Transition. She recently published a policy playbook, Critical Minerals and the Future of the United States Economy, and is now writing a book on an international strategy for critical minerals engagement for the United States.)* "New Executive Order Ties U.S. Critical Minerals Security to Global Partnerships" Accessed January 20, 2026 <https://www.csis.org/analysis/new-executive-order-ties-us-critical-minerals-security-global-partnerships#:~:text=During%20President%20Trump%27s%20second%20term,with%20allied%20and%20partner%20countries.>

During President Trump's second term, critical minerals have emerged as a prominent element of U.S. foreign policy. The administration has pursued a series of bilateral agreements aimed at securing access to mineral resources and strengthening supply chains with key partners, including Ukraine, Saudi Arabia, Thailand, Malaysia, Japan, and the Democratic Republic of the Congo. These agreements have focused on expanding upstream investment, processing cooperation, and long-term offtake arrangements, reflecting a broader effort to reduce U.S. dependence on adversarial suppliers while deepening economic and strategic ties with allied and partner countries.

MPX) Status Quo Solving

Inherency 2) New Reforms to the DFC

DFC.gov, no author listed December 18th, 2025 "DFC Secures Expanded Authorities with FY26 NDAA Signed into Law" <https://www.dfc.gov/media/press-releases/dfc-secures-expanded-authorities-fy26-ndaa-signed-law> Accessed December 21st 2025

"The U.S. International Development Finance Corporation (DFC) today secured a six-year reauthorization and expanded authorities with President Trump's signing of the Fiscal Year (FY) 2026 National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA) into law. (Later on) Highlights of DFC's reauthorization include: Six-year authorization through December 31, 2031. \$205 billion investment cap (Maximum Contingent Liability ("MCL")) – an increase of over 300%. Creation of a \$5 billion equity revolving fund. Increased equity investment authority to 40% minority ownership. Increased investment authority to cover all international geographies other than the wealthiest twenty countries. DFC may still invest in the wealthiest twenty countries but only via investments in the Five Eyes (Australia, Canada, New Zealand, the United Kingdom and the United States) countries and territories and investments in certain sectors. The sectoral exemptions are for energy, critical minerals and rare earths, and information and communications technology, including undersea cables. No more than 10 percent of the MCL may be used in wealthy and other high-income countries, regardless of any country, territory or sector exceptions."

MPX) Let the New System Work**Inherency) New DFC Investment**

[DFC.gov](https://www.dfc.gov), no author listed February 4th 2026 “DFC Highlights Landmark Critical Minerals Investments to Strengthen U.S. National Security During State Department Ministerial”

<https://www.dfc.gov/media/press-releases/dfc-highlights-landmark-critical-minerals-investments-strengthen-us-national> Accessed February 11th 2026

Recent DFC critical minerals investments include:

Gécamines/Mercuria: Following the issuance of DFC’s letter of interest in December, the Democratic Republic of Congo’s state-owned enterprise Gécamines, through its trading joint venture with commodity trader Mercuria, has sold and started shipping approximately 100,000 tons of copper committed to the United States and plans to sell and ship an additional 50,000 tons to the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates. These transactions reflect a shared commitment to strengthening secure and diversified critical mineral supply chains, consistent with the objectives outlined in the prospective joint venture.

Serra Verde: DFC has signed a financing agreement with SVRE Holdings Ltd. for a \$565 million loan to optimize and expand the Pela Ema rare earths mine in Brazil, which will help develop a Western-aligned source of rare earth elements, including heavy rare earth elements.

Cove Kaz Capital: DFC has issued Letters Of Intent exploring up to \$700 million for both debt financing and project development funding for Cove Kaz Capital Group’s investment in the Severniy Katpar Tungsten Mine in Kazakhstan.

Critical Minerals Consortium: As of January 2026, DFC closed on its \$600 million investment in the Orion Critical Mineral Consortium (Orion CMC), a landmark \$1.8 billion public-private partnership jointly established by DFC, Orion Resource Partners LP, and ADQ. Through this platform, the partners will invest in critical mineral projects across DFC-eligible jurisdictions. Orion will originate and lead transactions, while DFC and ADQ retain the ability to provide strategic guidance and participate on a deal-by-deal basis. The consortium is designed to deploy capital flexibly across debt, equity, and production-linked instruments (including royalties, streams, and offtakes) and currently has a robust pipeline of global critical minerals opportunities under evaluation.

URIF: DFC made a \$75 million equity investment in the United States-Ukraine Reconstruction Investment Fund, which is matched by the Ukrainian government for a total of \$150M, to invest in critical minerals and other strategic sectors in Ukraine.

A/T Harms/Significance

A/T Need to Beat China → US is Already Beating China

Application) Serra Verde Mine

Muflih Hidayat, December 6, 2025, *(Muflih Hidayat brings over nine years of experience in journalism, government and external relations, and B2B event management within the mining sector. He specialises in connecting industry stakeholders through high-level forums, strategic engagement, and advocacy initiatives, bridging business interests with public narratives to deliver impact-driven communications that support sustainable industrial growth.)* “Serra Verde Shortens Chinese Offtakes for Strategic Western Partnerships” Accessed January 7, 2026

<https://discoveryalert.com.au/serra-verde-contract-termination-2025-supply-chain-impact/>

Serra Verde's decision to terminate Chinese contracts in 2026 reflects calculated strategic positioning rather than operational necessity. The timing coincides with anticipated commissioning of Western heavy rare earth separation facilities across multiple regions. This synchronisation creates the first legitimate opportunity for Western supply chain integration in the heavy REE sector.

The \$465 million DFC loan approval validates both the deposit's geological merits and its strategic importance to U.S. supply chain security objectives. DFC financing typically requires rigorous technical and commercial due diligence, suggesting confidence in Serra Verde's production capabilities and market positioning.

Sig 1) Diversifying Supply Chain

A) Domestic Production Increasing

Gabe Neville, writing for the Global Policy Watch, in October of 2025 *(Gabe Neville is a senior advisor at the law firm Covington & Burling LLP, who after nearly two decades as a senior congressional staffer (including serving as chief of staff to Joe Pitts, U.S. Representative for Pennsylvania's 16th district) now helps clients navigate federal legislative and regulatory processes.) (Global Policy Watch is a policy and regulatory blog managed by Covington & Burling LLP, offering insights and analysis on international public policy, legislation, and regulatory developments affecting global businesses, with contributions from former government officials and legal experts.)* Accessed October 22, 2025. “Made in America: The Outlook for Critical Minerals” <https://www.globalpolicywatch.com/2025/10/made-in-america-the-outlook-for-critical-minerals/> After first using the authority primarily for wind energy projects, the Biden Administration used FAST-41 (a process created in the 2015 Highway Bill to expedite major infrastructure projects) to approve a mine for the first time in 2023. **Since then, the Trump Administration has used FAST-41 to approve copper, Stibnite (antimony ore), lithium, copper, and phosphate mines on U.S. soil. President Biden included critical minerals in his February 2021 Executive Order on “America’s Supply Chains” (EO 14017). President Trump has issued five orders related to critical minerals, including one in 2020 declaring U.S. reliance on foreign adversaries a national emergency (EO 13953). He has issued further executive orders this year to help accelerate domestic production and processing, conduct a Section 232 investigation on imports of processed minerals and derivative products, and expedite permitting and development of seabed mining.**

B) Australian CMA

Spencer Kimball October of 2025 *(Spencer Kimball is an Energy Reporter at CNBC who covers energy markets, policy, and regulation.) Writing for CNBC (CNBC is a leading business news network owned by NBCUniversal, known for providing real-time financial market coverage, economic analysis, and business reporting to a global audience across television, digital platforms, and live events.) Accessed October 22, 2025 “U.S. and Australia sign critical minerals agreement with \$8.5 billion project pipeline”*

<https://www.cnbc.com/2025/10/20/trump-australia-albanese-minerals-rare-earths-china.html?msocid=3356e1df53866be50940f27f52f86a10>

President Donald Trump and Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese on Monday signed an agreement on critical minerals and rare earths that Albanese said includes plans for projects worth a total of up to \$8.5 billion. Later... “In about a year from now, we’ll have so much critical mineral and rare earths that you won’t know what to do with them,” Trump told reporters. The U.S. is also working with other nations to build a supply chain that isn’t dependent on China, the president said.

C) Japan CMA

The Office of the United States Trade Representative Writing in March of 2023 *(The Office of the United States Trade Representative (USTR) is a federal agency responsible for developing and coordinating U.S. international trade, commodity, and direct investment policy, and overseeing trade negotiations with foreign governments to promote American economic interests.) Accessed October 22, 2025. “United States and Japan Sign Critical Minerals Agreement”.*

<https://ustr.gov/about-us/policy-offices/press-office/press-releases/2023/march/united-states-and-japan-sign-critical-minerals-agreement>

United States Trade Representative Katherine Tai and Japan’s Ambassador to the United States, Tomita Koji, today signed a critical minerals agreement (“Agreement Between the Government of Japan and the Government of the United States of America on Strengthening Critical Minerals Supply Chains”). The Agreement builds on the 2019 U.S.-Japan Trade Agreement and will strengthen and diversify critical minerals supply chains and promote the adoption of electric vehicle battery technologies.

D) Ukraine CMA

Luca Léry Moffat, December 18, 2025, *(Luca is the economics reporter for the Kyiv Independent. He was previously a research analyst at Bruegel, a Brussels-based economics think tank, where he worked on Russia and Ukraine, trade, industrial policy, and environmental policy. Luca also worked as a data analyst at Work-in-Data, a Geneva-based research center focused on global inequality, and as a research assistant at the Economic Policy Research Center in Kampala, Uganda. He holds a BA honors degree in economics and Russian from McGill University.) “US, Ukraine minerals deal will finally go live in 2026” Accessed January 15, 2026*

<https://kyivindependent.com/us-ukraine-minerals-deal-will-finally-go-live-in-2026/>

The joint U.S.-Ukraine investment fund, known as the minerals deal, will go live early next year, Ukraine's Economy Ministry said in a press release. The fund's board of directors reached final consensus on several administrative steps on Dec. 18, paving the way for the fund to accept investments starting in early 2026, the statement said. Ukraine signed a so-called "minerals deal" with the U.S. in April 2025, which established a joint investment fund in Ukraine and gives the U.S. favorable access to investment projects in Ukraine.

E) Argentina Framework Agreement

The White House, November 13, 2025, “JOINT STATEMENT ON FRAMEWORK FOR A UNITED STATES-ARGENTINA AGREEMENT ON RECIPROCAL TRADE AND INVESTMENT” Accessed November 15, 2025
<https://www.whitehouse.gov/briefings-statements/2025/11/joint-statement-on-framework-for-a-united-states-argentina-agreement-on-reciprocal-trade-and-investment>

“In pursuit of a stronger, more balanced economic partnership, the United States and Argentina have agreed to a Framework to deepen bilateral trade and investment cooperation. This Framework for an Agreement on Reciprocal Trade and Investment (Agreement) seeks to drive long-term growth, expand opportunity, and create a transparent and rules-based environment for commerce and innovation. The outcome reflects the countries’ shared ambition and values, and builds on actions Argentina has already taken to modernize its trade and investment regime and foster reciprocal conditions.”

F) DFC Investment into Brazil

DFC on Aug 15 2025 *The United States International Development Finance Corporation (DFC) is a development finance institution and agency of the United States federal government. DFC invests in development projects primarily in lower and middle-income countries. First authorized on 5 October 2018 by the BUILD Act, the independent agency was formed on December 20, 2019 by merging the Overseas Private Investment Corporation (OPIC) with the Development Credit Authority (DCA) of the United States Agency for International Development (USAID), as well as with several other smaller offices and funds. DFC's lending capacity is used to provide loans, loan guarantees, direct equity investments, and political risk insurance for private-sector led development projects, feasibility studies, and technical assistance] DFC invests across several sectors including energy, healthcare, critical infrastructure, and technology, with stated priorities of women's empowerment, innovation, investment in West Africa and the Western Hemisphere, and climate change.*
<https://www.dfc.gov/sites/default/files/media/documents/BDR%2825%2920%20SVRE%20Holding%20Ltd.pdf> access date 10/22/2025

BE IT RESOLVED, that the Board hereby approves financing under 22 U.S.C. § 9621(b) in the principal amount of up to \$465,000,000, plus interest thereon, to SVRE Holdings Ltd. for the purpose of financing (a) improvements to the Pela Ema mine, a brownfield rare earths mine located in the state of Goias, Brazil, (b) operational expenses, (c) refinancing of existing shareholder debt, and (d) reserve accounts and other transaction costs in Brazil.

G) EXIM (U.S. Export-Import Bank) Investing 100 Billion

No Author Provided, Reuters, November 23, 2025 *(Reuters, an international news agency owned by Thomson Reuters, was founded in 1851 by Paul Reuter. Headquartered in London, the agency operates in roughly 200 locations globally with approximately 2,500 journalists and 600 photojournalists, reporting in 16 languages. Reuters provides content via subscriptions to news organizations, businesses, and the public.) “US EXIM to invest \$100 billion to secure critical mineral supplies, FT says.” Accessed 1/9/2026*
<https://www.reuters.com/business/energy/us-exim-invest-100-billion-secure-critical-mineral-supplies-ft-says-2025-11-23/>

“The U.S. Export-Import Bank (EXIM) will invest \$100 billion to secure U.S. and allied supply chains for critical minerals, nuclear energy and liquefied natural gas, the organisation's chair John Jovanovic told the Financial Times in an interview published on Sunday.”

MPX) Burden: Prove Unique Need Aff Plan

Sig 2) Prioritizing Allies

Gracelin Baskaran, January 15, 2026, *(Dr. Gracelin Baskaran is director of the Critical Minerals Security Program at the Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS). She is a mining economist and has spent over a decade working on critical minerals globally. She began her career in South Africa's platinum belt and later spent five years at the World Bank in South Africa, where she coauthored the book Africa's Resource Future: Harnessing Natural Resources for Economic Transformation during the Low-Carbon Transition. She recently published a policy playbook, Critical Minerals and the Future of the United States Economy, and is now writing a book on an international strategy for critical minerals engagement for the United States.)* "New Executive Order Ties U.S. Critical Minerals Security to Global Partnerships" Accessed January 20, 2026 <https://www.csis.org/analysis/new-executive-order-ties-us-critical-minerals-security-global-partnerships#:~:text=During%20President%20Trump%27s%20second%20term,with%20allied%20and%20partner%20countries.>

The new EO makes clear that the United States is not pursuing an America-only approach to mineral security. Instead, it embeds critical minerals into a framework of allied cooperation, trade negotiation, and shared supply chain resilience, recognizing that no single country can secure these supply chains alone. By prioritizing agreements with trusted partners on processed minerals and pairing cooperation with clear trade consequences if vulnerabilities persist, the EO signals a shift toward global supply chain cooperation as a pillar of U.S. economic and national security strategy, rather than unilateral self-sufficiency.

Solvency

Solvency 1) (Lithium Specific) Investment Would Fail

A) Holistic Reforms Needed In Argentina

Sebastian D Penelli He is a graduate of the TEA School of Journalism and holds a degree in Journalism from the University of El Salvador. He has been working at *Ámbito Financiero* for over 15 years, but he has also held various positions at *Perfil*, *Infobae*, and *Criticadigital*. He worked in journalistic production at Canal 13 and Canal 26 in Buenos Aires. He is currently an editor and writer for the Buenos Aires Herald. **October 12th 2025** "Argentina's new 10-year lithium plan just dropped" <https://buenosairesherald.com/business/mining/argentinas-new-10-year-lithium-plan-just-dropped> Accessed December 30th 2025

In this context, Argentina faces two additional challenges that complement the struggle against international competition. First, the federal government and the nine mining provinces must find a definitive resolution to the Glacier Law and the Wetlands Law (two environmental laws that could potentially prohibit mining operations), through either the Supreme Court or Congress. Second, the country urgently needs a comprehensive upgrade of its energy infrastructure and its road and rail logistics systems to expand exports.

B) Chile Moving Away From Lithium

Gal Luft, co-director of the Institute for the Analysis of Global Security *The Dialogue* Accessed December 30th 2025 "Is Chile Losing Ground to Other Lithium Producers?" <https://thediologue.org/analysis/is-chile-losing-ground-to-other-lithium-producers>

The Chilean lithium industry scored a lot of headlines thanks to its role in the global green energy transition, but in reality, it is not a big player in Chile's economy, and it is not expected to ever become

one. Lithium carbonate makes up barely 1 percent of Chile's export revenues. The industry faces many detractors and challenges. Environmental groups and the Indigenous population are becoming increasingly agitated by the environmental impact of lithium production. The industry is increasingly being viewed as a liability rather than an asset. In addition, the idea of increasing mining royalties and even nationalization of key resources by a socialist government, while presently not on the agenda, is still in the public discourse, chilling investors' appetite to partake in the future development of the industry.

C) Bolivian Mining Halted

Reuters Diana Beth Solomon Reuters's latin american mining correspondent October 24th, 2025 "Bolivia's new president rekindles cautious hope for long-stalled lithium dreams"

<https://www.reuters.com/world/china/bolivias-new-president-rekindles-cautious-hope-long-stalled-lithium-dreams-2025-10-21/>

Accessed December 30th 2025

Bolivia holds the world's largest resources of the ultralight metal used in electric vehicle batteries, but development has been hamstrung by political opposition and a law mandating state control of the sector that has chilled broad investor interest. (Later on the article states) There are technical challenges, too, in tailoring extraction technology to the exact composition of the salty brine deposits that hold Bolivia's lithium. Past efforts with traditional evaporation ponds proved inefficient due in part to high naturally occurring concentrations of magnesium.

MPX) Unready for Investment

Solvency 2) (CMA Specific) IRA Credit Terminated

A) CMA's based on 30D IRA Credit

Congress.gov January 8, 2025, "U.S.-Japan Critical Minerals Agreement" Accessed November 14, 2025

<https://www.congress.gov/crs-product/IF12517>

The United States and Japan do not have a congressionally approved FTA, but the U.S. Department of the Treasury has designated the CMA as an FTA for the purposes of the IRA EV tax credit. (Later) The IRA provides consumers a tax credit of up to \$7,500 for new EVs (26 U.S.C. §30D)

B) 30D Credit Terminated

Arnold and Porter July 22, 2025, (Law Firm) “From IRA to OBBBA: A New Era for Clean Energy Tax Credits”

Accessed November 14, 2025

<https://www.arnoldporter.com/en/perspectives/advisories/2025/07/from-ira-to-obbbba-a-new-era-for-clean-energy-tax-credits>

The OBBBA will terminate several clean vehicle and residential energy credits over the next year. Section 25E (Previously Owned Clean Vehicle Credit), Section 30D (Clean Vehicle Credit), and Section 45W (Credit for Qualified Commercial Clean Vehicles) will terminate on September 30,

2025. Section 30C (Alternative Fuel Vehicle Refueling Property Credit) is terminated for property placed in service after June 30, 2026. Section 25C (Energy Efficient Home Improvement Credit) and Section 25D (Residential Clean Energy Credit) will terminate on December 31, 2025, and Section 45L (New Energy Efficient Home Credit) will terminate for homes acquired after June 30, 2026. Section 179D (Energy Efficient Commercial Buildings Deduction) will no longer be available for property beginning construction after June 30, 2026.

MPX) No Incentive for Other Countries to Negotiate

Solvency 3) Can’t Eliminate China

A) China Holds 90% of Processing Capacity

Eva Roytburg, November 18, 2025, (Eva Roytburg is a fellow on Fortune's News desk. She is also a graduate from Emory University with a degree in economics, politics, philosophy and law, who is fascinated by reporting in the intersections of business and politics.), Fortune, November 18, 2025, Accessed: 11/26/25,

<https://fortune.com/2025/11/18/rare-earth-american-trade-gap/>

By heavily subsidizing refining and magnet-making throughout the 1990s and 2000s, Beijing secured a near-monopoly over global production, Ghareman told Fortune. Today, China accounts for about 70% of rare-earth mining and nearly 90% of processing capacity, according to the U.S. Geological Survey and OECD trade data.

B) US Investment Can’t Combat China

Center For Strategic Intelligence Studies, September 2023 Erin Murphy, the deputy director for the Chair on India and Emerging Asia Economics and senior fellow of Emerging Asia Economics at the Center for Strategic and International Studies. She has spent her career in several public and private sector roles and more than two decades working in the Indo-Pacific. Daniel F. Runde During 14 years at CSIS, he served as senior vice president, director of the Project on Prosperity and Development, William A. Schreyer Chair in Global Analysis, and acting director of the Americas Program (2020–2022). A champion of U.S. soft power in the developing world, Runde helped craft the BUILD Act, secure the Export-Import Bank

(EXIM)'s 2018 reauthorization, and design Prosper Africa, while advancing U.S. leadership in multilateral institutions and World Bank Group reform., Romina Bandura a senior fellow with the Project on Prosperity and Development at the Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS). Ms. Bandura is an economist with 25 years of experience in international development research, policy analysis, and project management. and Noam Unger vice president of the Global Development Department, director of the Sustainable Development and Resilience Initiative, Previously, he served on the executive team and as a vice president at InterAction, the largest U.S.-based coalition of nongovernmental organizations focused on international development, humanitarian action, peacebuilding, global health, and democracy. "The Next Five Years of the DFC Ten Recommendations to Revamp the Agency"

https://csis-website-prod.s3.amazonaws.com/s3fs-public/2023-09/230928_Murphy_Years_DFC.pdf?VersionId=6h6j4dPcM83XQem6Ceplmamd_WOolHRU Accessed November 1st 2025

However, the DFC has been viewed by many in Washington as a silver bullet to counteract China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) and Global Development Initiative through major infrastructure investments—in other words, a way to showcase U.S. commitment to development in strategic areas and push private sector investment into risky countries. (The article concludes) The DFC is not, and should not be, the silver bullet it is often mistakenly purported to be.

MPX) China Still Monopolizes the Market

Solvency 4) US Uses Chinese Processing

A) Biggest Mine in US Exports to China

Alvin Camba, April 14, 2025, *(Alvin Camba is a Critical Materials Specialist at the Associated Universities Incorporated. He focuses on advancing research for the BEACONS Project, a strategic initiative funded by the U.S. Department of Defense. He received my PhD in Sociology from Johns Hopkins University. also a non-resident fellow at the Climate Policy Lab at the Fletcher School at Tufts University, the Stratbase-Alberto Del Rosario Institute (ADRI) in the Philippines, and the Paramadina Public Policy Institute (PPPI) in Indonesia having authored over 28 peer-reviewed publications, 17 policy reports, 14 book chapters, and more than 50 short-form essays.), War on Rocks, April 14, 2025, "A Federal Critical Mineral Processing Initiative: Securing U.S. Mineral Independence from China", Accessed January 20, 2026*

<https://warontherocks.com/2025/04/a-federal-critical-mineral-processing-initiative-securing-u-s-mineral-independence-from-china/>

U.S. efforts to reduce dependence on China for critical minerals face a number of significant hurdles. First, domestic refining expansion remains slow, with new processing plants and smelters taking 10–20 years to become operational. For example, the Mountain Pass Rare Earth Mine, which reopened after China's 2010 export controls, still sent 98 percent of its raw materials to China in 2019 due to the lack of U.S. processing capacity.

B) Plan does Nothing About Processing

MPX) No Decreased Reliance on China

Disadvantages

DA 1) Unprotected Investment

A) Investment in Serra Verde Mine

DFC on Aug 15 2025 *The United States International Development Finance Corporation (DFC) is a development finance institution and agency of the United States federal government. DFC invests in development projects primarily in lower and middle-income countries. First authorized on 5 October 2018 by the BUILD Act, the independent agency was formed on December 20, 2019 by merging the Overseas Private Investment Corporation (OPIC) with the Development Credit Authority (DCA) of the United States Agency for International Development (USAID), as well as with several other smaller offices and funds. DFC's lending capacity is used to provide loans, loan guarantees, direct equity investments, and political risk insurance for private-sector led development projects, feasibility studies, and technical assistance] DFC invests across several sectors including energy, healthcare, critical infrastructure, and technology, with stated priorities of women's empowerment, innovation, investment in West Africa and the Western Hemisphere, and climate change.*
<https://www.dfc.gov/sites/default/files/media/documents/BDR%2825%2920%20SVRE%20Holding%20Ltd.pdf> access date 10/22/2025

BE IT RESOLVED, that the Board hereby approves financing under 22 U.S.C. § 9621(b) in the principal amount of up to \$465,000,000, plus interest thereon, to SVRE Holdings Ltd. for the purpose of financing (a) improvements to the Pela Ema mine, a brownfield rare earths mine located in the state of Goias, Brazil, (b) operational expenses, (c) refinancing of existing shareholder debt, and (d) reserve accounts and other transaction costs in Brazil.

B) Minerals went to China

Bryan Harris and Meredith Schwartz, writing for The Center for Strategic and International Studies, on September 11, 2025 *(Bryan Harris is a managing partner at Sabio). (Meredith Schwartz is a research associate with the Critical Minerals Security Program at CSIS). (The Center for Strategic and International Studies is an American think tank based in Washington, D.C. From its founding in 1962 until 1987, it was an affiliate of Georgetown University, initially named the Center for Strategic and International Studies of Georgetown University.) Gracelin Baskaran, (Gracelin Baskaran is director of the Critical Minerals Security Program at the Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS) in Washington, D.C.). Accessed October 21 2025. "Friendshoring Copper: A New Pillar of the U.S.-Brazilian Economic Partnership". <https://www.csis.org/analysis/friendshoring-copper-new-pillar-us-brazilian-economic-partnership>*
 A cautionary example is the U.S.-led Minerals Security Partnership's support for Brazil's Serra Verde rare earth project, which produces both the light and heavy rare earth elements critical for magnet production. Despite this strategic backing led by the United States, it was later revealed that the project's offtake had already been contracted to Chinese entities, owing to China's near-monopoly on heavy rare earth refining—a gap that should have been addressed during initial structuring.

C) Aff has No Protection for the Investment

Aff has nothing Protecting their investment or agreement, meaning we could just see our investments fund China.

MPX) Aff Funds the Enemy

DA 2) CA/SA Critical Minerals are Too Expensive

A) Chilean Prices

Mysteel (a Chinese metallurgy company) quoting the Chilean Ministry of Commerce no author listed May 26th 2025 “FLASH: Chile's lithium exports up 26% YoY in 2024”

<https://www.mysteel.net/news/5087480-flash-chiles-lithium-exports-up-26-yoy-in-2024> Accessed January 2nd 2025

However, Chile's total lithium export value dropped to \$2.895 billion in 2024 due to the plummeting lithium prices, a 57% year-on-year decline. The average price of lithium carbonate fell to \$11,049/t, while lithium hydroxide averaged \$11,398/t.

B) Global Prices Lower

Reuters (as an author somehow?) Kitco News December 17th 2025 “Global lithium prices spike but remain below 2024 average, says Cochilco”

<https://www.kitco.com/news/off-the-wire/2025-12-17/global-lithium-prices-spike-remain-below-2024-average-says-cochilco> Accessed January 2nd 2025

The average price to date is \$9,306/ton, 24% lower than the \$12,296 registered in 2024. Higher consumption is projected for lithium battery energy storage systems, which has contributed to higher pricing.

MPX) 20% More Expensive in SA

MPX 2) Better to Invest Elsewhere

Argument Backup

R/T: Japan Deal Impotent → Recent Investment Commitments

Kristi Govella September 9th, 2025. *(Kristi Govella is an Associate Professor of Japanese Politics and International Relations at the University of Oxford and Senior Adviser and Japan Chair at the Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS). She specializes in the intersection of economics, security, and governance, with a focus on the Indo-Pacific region and Japan. Her research spans topics such as economic statecraft, regional institutional architecture, military alliances, and governance of the global commons. Prior to joining Oxford, she was the inaugural director of the Center for Indo-Pacific Affairs at the University of Hawai‘i at Mānoa and held roles at the German Marshall Fund, Harvard University, and the Daniel K. Inouye Asia-Pacific Center for Security Studies). Writing for The Center for Strategic and International Studies (The Center for Strategic and International Studies (CSIS) is a Washington, D.C.-based think tank that conducts policy research and strategic analysis on global security, economic, and political issues to inform decision-makers in government, business, and civil society). Accessed October 28th, 2025. “New documents reveal next steps for U.S.-Japan trade deal”.*

<https://www.csis.org/analysis/new-documents-reveal-next-steps-us-japan-trade-deal>

On the same day that the EO was released, Japanese lead negotiator Ryosei Akazawa and Secretary of Commerce Howard Lutnick signed an MOU designed to clarify how Japan’s promised \$550 billion in investment is expected to flow into the United States. The MOU clarifies the originally ambiguous timeline, stating that investments included under the framework agreement must be made before the end of Trump’s second term on January 19, 2029. It also reiterates that investments will be made in sectors that advance economic and security interests, including semiconductors, pharmaceuticals, metals, critical minerals, shipbuilding, energy (including pipelines), AI, and quantum computing.

A/T: Australia Deal Bad → Reducing Dependency

Masters in International Relations Maria Siow October 24th, 2025 *(Maria Siow is a senior Asia correspondent at the South China Morning Post, specializing in East Asian affairs, security, and economic policy, with over two decades of media experience and a master's degree in international relations. She is currently based in Beijing and previously served as China Bureau Chief and East Asia Bureau Chief for Channel NewsAsia, where she helped establish its China office. Her reporting spans regional diplomacy, critical minerals, and geopolitical developments across Asia, Australia, and the Pacific Islands). With the South China Morning Post (The South China Morning Post (SCMP) is a Hong Kong-based English-language newspaper founded in 1903, known for its comprehensive coverage of Greater China and Asia-Pacific affairs, with a focus on politics, business, and culture, and owned by Alibaba Group since 2016). Accessed October 28th, 2025. "Australia scores big win in US with critical minerals deal, Aukus commitment".*

<https://www.scmp.com/week-asia/politics/article/3330097/australia-scores-big-win-us-critical-minerals-deal-aukus-commitment>

During Australian Prime Minister [Anthony Albanese](#)'s visit to the White House on Monday, the two countries signed a [critical minerals](#) agreement aimed at reducing their dependency on dominant supplier China and strengthening supply chains for key industries.

The deal will see Canberra and Washington invest US\$1 billion over the next six months in mining and processing projects and set a price floor for the critical minerals.

Backup Card) Serra Verde Minerals to China

Jack Nicas In April 2025 *(Jack Nicas is a journalist who has served as Brazil Bureau Chief at The New York Times, previously worked as a staff reporter for The Wall Street Journal, and holds degrees from Boston University.) Writing for the New York Times (The New York Times is a globally recognized American newspaper founded in 1851, known for its award-winning journalism, rigorous fact-checking, and comprehensive coverage of national and international news.) Accessed October 28, 2025. "The Mine Is American. The Minerals Are China's."*

<https://archive.is/20250416191819/https://www.nytimes.com/2025/04/16/world/americas/brazil-mine-rare-earths-china.html#section-4543.0-4575.88>

After 14 years — and an additional \$150 million from American and British investors — the Serra Verde mine opened last year in Minaçu, Brazil, a town of 30,000 in central Brazil built around a decades-old asbestos mine. Everything the mine extracted was already contracted to go to China.

Sig Backup) EVEN MORE MINERAL DEALS

Ian Saccomanno, January 16, 2026, *(Senior Trade Analyst, Washington, DC) "President Trump orders critical minerals trade negotiations in Section 232 action" Accessed January 21, 2026*

[https://www.whitecase.com/insight-alert/president-trump-orders-critical-minerals-trade-negotiations-section-232-action#:~:text=President%20Trump%20orders%20critical%20minerals%20trade%20negotiations%20in%20Section%20232%20action,-Alert&text=On%20January%2014%2C%202026%2C%20President.their%20derivative%20products%20\(PCMDPs\).&text=In%20the%20proclamation%2C%20President%20Trump.not%20achieve%20their%20intended%20outcomes](https://www.whitecase.com/insight-alert/president-trump-orders-critical-minerals-trade-negotiations-section-232-action#:~:text=President%20Trump%20orders%20critical%20minerals%20trade%20negotiations%20in%20Section%20232%20action,-Alert&text=On%20January%2014%2C%202026%2C%20President.their%20derivative%20products%20(PCMDPs).&text=In%20the%20proclamation%2C%20President%20Trump.not%20achieve%20their%20intended%20outcomes)

The Trump administration has signed bilateral critical mineral development agreements with Argentina, Australia, Cambodia, Japan, Malaysia, and Thailand, establishing new cooperation frameworks, market access commitments, and identifying potential projects worth over \$10 billion. The United States also hosted a business development event with five Central Asian countries, leading to an agreement with Kazakhstan to enhance supply chain resilience and promote new commercial opportunities in the region. These agreements are with both mineral-rich countries, such as Australia and Kazakhstan, and with advanced downstream processing capabilities, like Japan.